

Brother Sam (Ya Sap!)

A song for Samuel Olubunmi Latunde at 70

Yoruba lines are shown in gold, with their meaning underneath

INTRO

Come see this, come see this!
Let's bring it home to today's parlance:
Brother Sam is seventy!

VERSE 1

Liverpool baby, born by the sea,
Six years old, on a ship to Ibadan, sailing free.
Maryhill, Lagelu, Poly, then Ife,
A library card and big dreams for life.
Mama Aderinsola, a nurse with healing hands,
Papa Deinde, the bursar, helped him understand.
But Mama held him through the longest nights,
Mama, see your boy: seventy and shining bright!

CHORUS

(Àádọ́rin ọdún! Ọlọ́run ṣé!)

Seventy years! God has done it!

Brother Sam is seventy, oh!
Don't let small things bother you,
Strength through the storm, he's coming through!
(Ọpẹ́ fún Olúwa!)

Thanks be to the Lord!

Seventy years and the beat goes on,
Come see this, come see this:
Brother Sam, still going strong!

VERSE 2

Westminster, the security desk,
A lady walking out, he said "Excuse me", you know the rest!
Abiola stopped, and she's stayed ever since,
Thirty-eight years married to her prince!
Folake, Ayobami, Ayotunde,
The pride of his life every single day.
And Akpan, Nathaniel, the one we proudly claim,
Sam lights up whenever he calls his name!

CHORUS

(Àádọ́rin ọdún! Ọlọ́run ṣé!)

Seventy years! God has done it!

Brother Sam is seventy, oh!
Don't let small things bother you,
Strength through the storm, he's coming through!
(Ọpẹ́ fún Olúwa!)

Thanks be to the Lord!

Seventy years and the beat goes on,
Come see this, come see this:
Brother Sam, still going strong!

VERSE 3

Seventy years with the sickle cell,
Never let it steal his smile, oh no!
At death's door he was cracking jokes,
Dressed like Baba Sala, fooling all the folks.
Rushed to emergency, nobody believed,
But God had the final word, and we are relieved!
Strength through the storm, grace never fails,
Here we are today to tell the tale!

BRIDGE

No lessons, just a broom and a phone book,
Beat it out till the whole house shook!
Now he's on the keys and the church is clapping,
Think he can't play?

EVERYBODY!

YA SAP!

BREAKDOWN

Who can talk to anybody? (Brother Sam!)
Who makes strangers feel at home? (Brother Sam!)
Good food, sci-fi, library books! (Brother Sam!)
New Covenant since eighty-nine! (Brother Sam!)
Humble in the morning, wise at night,
Seventy years and he's still just right!

FINAL CHORUS

(Àádọ́rin ọdún! Ọlọ́run ṣé!)

Seventy years! God has done it!

Brother Sam is seventy, oh!
Don't let small things bother you,
Strength through the storm, he's coming through!

(Ọpẹ́ fún Olúwa!)

Thanks be to the Lord!

Mama, *a dúpẹ́ o*

Mama, we thank you

look at your son:
Come see this, come see this,
Brother Sam, still going strong!

OUTRO

Happy seventieth birthday, Brother Sam!
We love you!

Àádọ́rin ọdún — seventy years · Ọlọ́run ṣé — God has done it · Ọpẹ́ fún Olúwa — thanks be to the Lord · A dúpẹ́ o — we thank you